



THE ALZHEIMER'S DECODER

10 THINGS EVERYONE SHOULD UNDERSTAND



1 It's a disease, not aging

Alzheimer's is a specific brain disease, not a normal part of getting older.

#1 cause of dementia

2 Plaques and tangles

Abnormal proteins build up and disrupt how brain cells communicate.

3 Memory first

Recent memory is usually affected earliest as the hippocampus is hit.

4 It progresses

Symptoms worsen over years, from mild forgetfulness to full dependence.

5 Risk rises with age

Age is the biggest risk factor, but it is not inevitable.

~1 in 9 over 65

6 Genes matter, partly

Some genes raise risk, but lifestyle and health also play a role.

7 Brain-healthy habits help

Exercise, sleep, learning and social ties support brain resilience.

8 Early detection counts

Earlier diagnosis opens more options for care and planning.

9 Caregivers need support

Care is demanding — support and respite protect caregiver health.

10 Research is advancing

New treatments and tests are emerging; understanding drives progress.

Source: Alzheimer's Association, 2024. Educational summary; not medical advice.

KNOW THE SIGNS. UNDERSTAND THE SCIENCE.